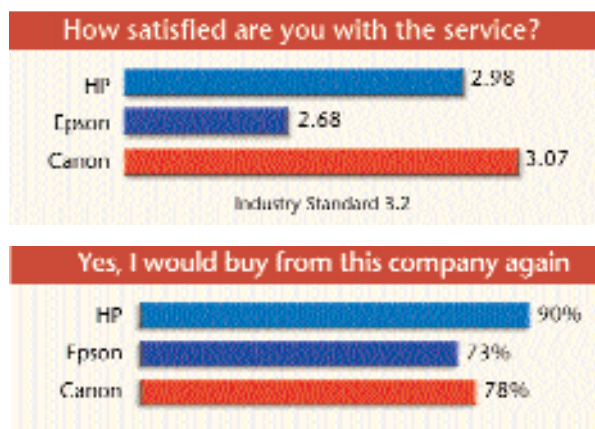




ers work well as long as the print cartridge used is genuine, and not refilled. When the cartridge is refilled, the printer goes kaput!” He goes on to point that “HP very clearly states that refills are not tolerated by their printer—using genuine cartridges, my printer is now in its seventh year.” One

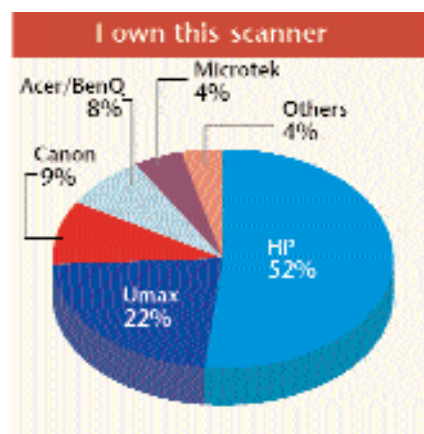
particular user of an Epson printer, Sameer Bhargava from New Delhi, opines that “it is good that third-party ink cartridges are available which lowers the running cost.” Alongside cost of cartridges, drying up of ink is also a source of worry for most users. As Jayesh Mehta, a businessman from Mumbai points out, using his Canon printer as an example, “There is a major problem of cartridges drying up, if the printer is not in continuous use.”

MOST RELIABLE PRINTER: Canon RUNNER-UP: HP
MOST SATISFACTORY SERVICE: Canon RUNNER-UP: HP

Scanners

Winner for scanners is **CANON**

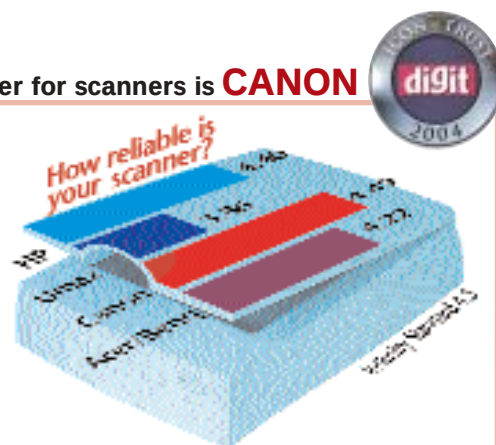
Not so long ago, a printer and a scanner were considered expensive accessories to a computer. Over time, however, reduction in prices have brought them within the easy reach of one-and-all, and both these devices find greater usage in homes and offices.



this category, followed by UMAX and Canon. With their large number of service centres strewn all over India, “Service most widely and promptly available”, is a common chant amongst users of HP. HP customers, therefore, are generally happy with their products.

However, HP’s technical support is not as good as Canon’s : with feedback such as “Very little help from the technical persons”, Canon steals the carpet from under HP when it comes to service. Indeed, praise for Canon is ubiquitous with hardly a negative comment in its name. From “Very handy and good scanner”, “very good for home usage”, “best scanner”, “Canon has kept its mark”, to “best company for scanners”, Canon seems to have captured the hearts of its customers.

One of the reasons for such a stellar showing could be alluded to the fact that



this company’s doorstep. Anish Gangar, an online content writer complained that “My UMAX 3400U scanner started giving problems within a year, and is still lying dead on my computer table. UMAX is the worst company, and I do not recommend my friends or colleagues to go in for UMAX products.”

Jaideep Khanduja an IT professional claims that his UMAX 2000 scans even a white page with a green background. Pratima Sawe, a computer consultant from Mumbai, was asked to replace

A product worth the money

Nikhil Kumar Desai, on his Canon scanner
Hyderabad, Andhra Pradesh

So much so that, one can now opt for an all-in-one device at the same price a printer or a scanner would have commanded a few months back.

The devices are so interlinked that their manufacturers make appearances under both the categories, you will find that HP is as synonymous to scanning or printing as Xerox is to copiers. HP commands the largest chunk of votes under

Canon has an on-site replacement warranty—you do not have to leave your home or office in case something goes wrong with your scanner. Canon does equally well as a reliable scanner. It wins the highest score for both the Reliability and the Service Indices.

Umax scanners got quite a beating—everything from bad-quality scans to bad service to faulty lamps were placed on

Customers of Canon
recorded the most satisfaction with repaired or replaced **scanner**, were most happy with the technical support offered and their problems were **solved** the **quickest**